

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Big Stick Diplomacy and the Monroe Doctrine, 1823–1904

US.21 — Assess the causes of American imperialism in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, including the desire for raw materials and new markets, American nationalism, and yellow journalism.

US.25 — Explain the causes of World War I, including militarism, alliances, nationalism, imperialism, assassination, and the reasons for the initial declaration of U.S. neutrality.

TEACHER EDITION — scoring guide and expected evidence. Not for student distribution.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Directions. Read the two documents below. Then write a well-organized essay addressing the following question: How did the Roosevelt Corollary transform the Monroe Doctrine from a defensive statement into an instrument of American imperial power, and what were the consequences for U.S.–Latin American relations? Your essay must: — Apply HIPP analysis to both documents — Construct a clear argument that evaluates the transformation from Monroe to Roosevelt — Incorporate outside knowledge of specific U.S. interventions in Latin America — Address the long-term consequences for U.S.–Latin American relations

The sources

Document 1

President James Monroe, Annual Message to Congress (Monroe Doctrine), December 2, 1823 — Bryan, William Jennings, ed., *Republic or Empire* (1899), public domain, public domain

“We owe it therefore to candor and to the amicable relations existing between the United States and those [European] powers to declare that we should consider any attempt on their part to extend their system to any portion of this hemisphere as dangerous to our peace and safety. With the existing colonies or dependencies of any European power we have not interfered and shall not interfere. But with the Governments who have declared their independence and whose independence we have acknowledged, we could not view any interposition for the purpose of oppressing them, or controlling in any other manner their destiny, by any European power, in any other light than as the manifestation of an unfriendly disposition toward the United States.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 1

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document 2

President Theodore Roosevelt, Roosevelt Corollary to the Monroe Doctrine, Annual Message to Congress, December 6, 1904 — Bryan, William Jennings, ed., *Republic or Empire* (1899), public domain, public domain

“Chronic wrongdoing, or an impotence which results in a general loosening of the ties of civilized society, may in America, as elsewhere, ultimately require intervention by some civilized nation, and in the Western Hemisphere the adherence of the United States to the Monroe Doctrine may force the United States, however reluctantly, to the exercise of an international police power in cases of such wrongdoing or impotence... We would interfere with them only in the last resort, and then only if it became evident that their inability or unwillingness to do justice at home and abroad had violated the rights of the United States or had invited foreign aggression to the detriment of the entire body of American nations.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 2

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

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hear it?

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The question

DOCUMENT 2 President Theodore Roosevelt, Roosevelt Corollary to the Monroe Doctrine, Annual Message to Congress, December 6, 1904 — Bryan, William Jennings, ed., Republic or Empire (1899), public domain, public domain: "Chronic wrongdoing, or an impotence which results in a general loosening of the ties of civilized society, may in America, as elsewhere, ultimately require intervention by some civilized nation, and in the Western Hemisphere the adherence of the United States to the Monroe Doctrine may force the United States, however reluctantly, to the exercise of an international police power in cases of such wrongdoing or impotence... We would interfere with them only in the last resort, and then only if it became evident that their inability or unwillingness to do justice at home and abroad had violated the rights of the United States or had invited foreign aggression to the detriment of the entire body of American nations."

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document 1		
Document 2		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

Scoring guide

Pts	6-point scale
6	Exemplary. Complex, specific thesis arguing the transformation from defensive to offensive/imperial. HIPP analysis of both documents accurately — including Monroe's 'not interfere' language and Roosevelt's 'police power' claim, with explicit contrast between them. Extensive outside knowledge (Venezuela Crisis, Dominican Republic, Haiti, Nicaragua, Good Neighbor Policy). Long-term consequences for U.S.-Latin American relations addressed specifically and accurately.
5	Advanced. Clear thesis. Accurate HIPP of both documents. Good outside knowledge. Addresses transformation and consequences but may not achieve full nuance of how Roosevelt's language inverts Monroe's.
4	Proficient. Clear thesis. Both documents used as evidence. HIPP of at least one document accurately. Some outside knowledge. Argument is coherent if not fully nuanced.
3	Adequate. Thesis present. Both documents used. Some HIPP elements. Limited outside knowledge. Some organizational issues.
2	Developing. Weak thesis. Uses documents without HIPP. Minimal outside knowledge.
1	Beginning. No thesis. Minimal document use.
0	No response or completely off-topic.

Expected evidence and document analysis. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS: — Doc 1 (Monroe): Note 'not interfered and shall not interfere' as a promise of non-intervention in existing colonies; the purpose is deterrence of European return, not assertion of U.S. control; the audience is primarily European powers. — Doc 2 (Roosevelt): Note 'chronic wrongdoing,' 'civilized nation,' 'international police power' as the operative phrases; Roosevelt's Point of View assumes Latin American inferiority; the audience includes both the U.S. Congress and Latin American governments; the Occasion is the Venezuela/Dominican fiscal crises. KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: Venezuela Boundary Crisis (1902–03); Dominican Republic customs control (1905); Cuba Platt Amendment; Panama Canal acquisition; U.S. in Haiti (1915–34); U.S. in Nicaragua (1912–33); Good Neighbor Policy (1933); Latin American nationalist movements; dollar diplomacy as successor policy under Taft.

Sourcing. Every document above carries its own citation as written in the item record. Verify each against the holding institution before classroom use — an unsourced primary source is worse than a missing one.

